

Sakkubai Outwits Dacoits

"The dacoits are coming!" **shouted** a villager as he ran to the village chief's house. The chief was talking to a few villagers.

"Calm down," he told the man. "Tell us who told you about the dacoits."

The villager told them how he had **overheard** it when he was passing through the **neighbouring** village.

"We have only a **handful** of **able-bodied** men in our village," said the chief, **worriedly**. "The dacoits will **outnumber** us. How do we fight them?"

"We have to **match** them with **wit**," said his wife, Sakkubai. "Weapons will not help us."

However, the men decided to catch the dacoits unawares. As night fell, they **lay in wait** for the robbers.

Sakkubai, however, had other plans. As soon as she heard about the dacoits, she cleaned her house, cooked a delicious meal, polished her brass lamps and **lit** them. Then she placed all her jewels on a tray and waited for the dacoits to come.

Before long there was a loud **thud** at the door. Sakkubai opened the door and **greeted** the dacoits with a welcoming smile.

"I'm so happy you have come to my house," she said respectfully to the leader of the dacoits. "Please allow me to serve dinner to you and your men."

After dinner, Sakkubai presented the tray full of her jewels to the leader.

"You can have all my jewellery, dear brother. Only, allow me to keep my mangalsutra as it's my wedding chain."

The leader of the dacoits felt **ashamed**. No one had treated him so well before.

"You **addressed** me as your brother and showed me such **kindness**," he said **gruffly**, his voice **choking** with emotion.

"How can I take any of your jewels? No, we shan't take anything from you, and in future, we shall never **rob** your village."



Later that night, the chief told his wife how the dacoits had tied them to trees and then a few hours later they had returned and **set** them **free**.

“Very **strange**!” said the chief, over and over again.

“Not strange at all,” replied Sakkubai, and she told him what had happened.

The chief could not believe that his wife had used her wits to **outwit** the dacoits.

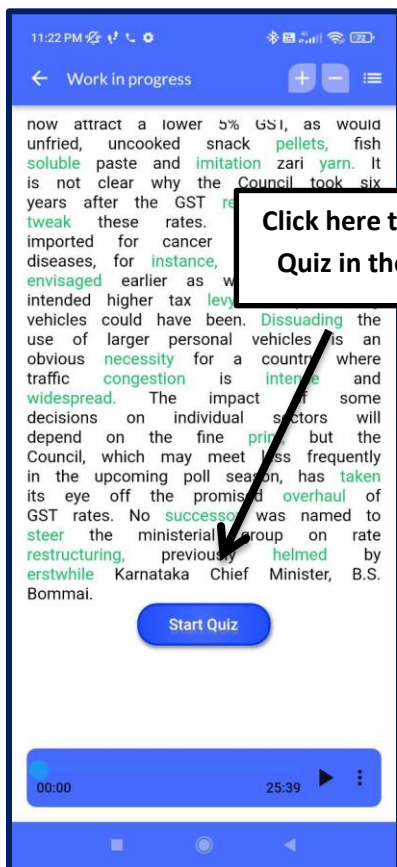
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Vocabulary

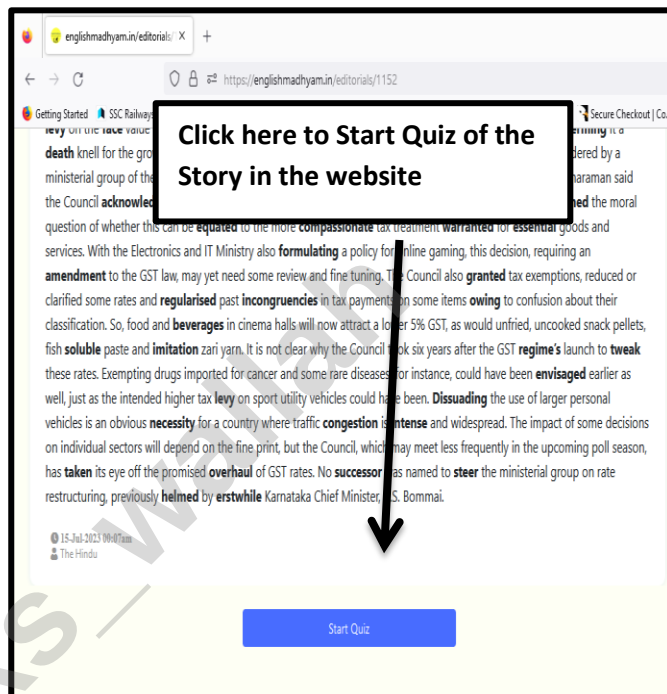
1. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, call, bellow, cry
– चिल्लाना
2. **Overhear** (verb) – catch, listen in, eavesdrop, intercept, pick up – अनजाने में सुन लेना
3. **Neighbouring** (adjective) – adjacent, nearby, close, bordering, adjoining – पड़ोसी
4. **A handful of** (noun) – a few, a small number, limited, some, not many – मुट्ठी भर / थोड़े
5. **Able-bodied** (adjective) – fit, healthy, strong, robust, capable – तंदुरुस्त / सक्षम
6. **Worriedly** (adverb) – anxiously, nervously, restlessly, tensely, fearfully – चिंतित होकर
7. **Outnumber** (verb) – exceed, surpass, overwhelm, be more than, outmatch – संख्या में अधिक होना
8. **Match** (verb) – equal, compete, rival, counter, oppose – बराबरी करना
9. **Wit** (noun) – intelligence, cleverness, sharpness, wisdom, ingenuity – बुद्धिमत्ता / चतुराई
10. **Lie in wait** (phrase) – ambush, hide, lurk, conceal, stay hidden – घात लगाना
11. **Light** (verb) – ignite, kindle, illuminate, spark, turn on – जलाना / रोशन करना
12. **Thud** (noun) – bang, bump, thump, knock, slam – धमाका / भारी आवाज
13. **Greet** (verb) – welcome, receive, address, salute, meet – स्वागत करना
14. **Ashamed** (adjective) – embarrassed, guilty, regretful, remorseful, humiliated – शर्मिदा
15. **Kindness** (noun) – compassion, generosity, goodwill, sympathy, gentleness – दयालुता / कृपा
16. **Gruffly** (adverb) – harshly, roughly, abruptly, bluntly, curtly – रूखेपन से / कठोरता से
17. **Choke** (verb) – gag, suffocate, struggle to speak, falter, stifle – गला भर आना / घुटना
18. **Rob** (verb) – steal, loot, plunder, burgle, raid – लूटना
19. **Set free** (phrasal verb) – release, liberate, unbind, let go, discharge – आज़ाद करना
20. **Strange** (adjective) – unusual, odd, bizarre, peculiar, unfamiliar – अजीब / असामान्य
21. **Outwit** (verb) – outsmart, trick, deceive, fool, baffle – चालाकी से हराना

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Practice Exercise



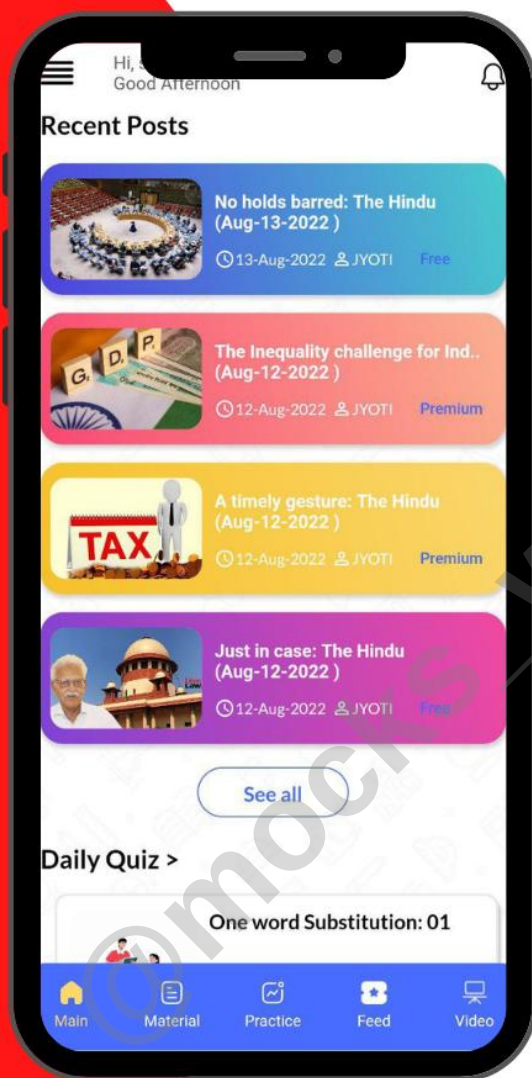
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